AQE

AI Deployment Qualification Engine

Qualification Certificate · UK Jurisdiction

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AQE is a deterministic AI deployment qualification engine. This document is a Qualification Certificate: a verdict issued under versioned rules, supported by the Evidence Book that follows.

Organisation	Northgate Wealth Partners (fictional)
Reference	AQE-F203B108
Sector	Financial Services
Jurisdiction	UK
Generated	15/10/2026
Classification	Confidential

AI QUALIFICATION DECISION

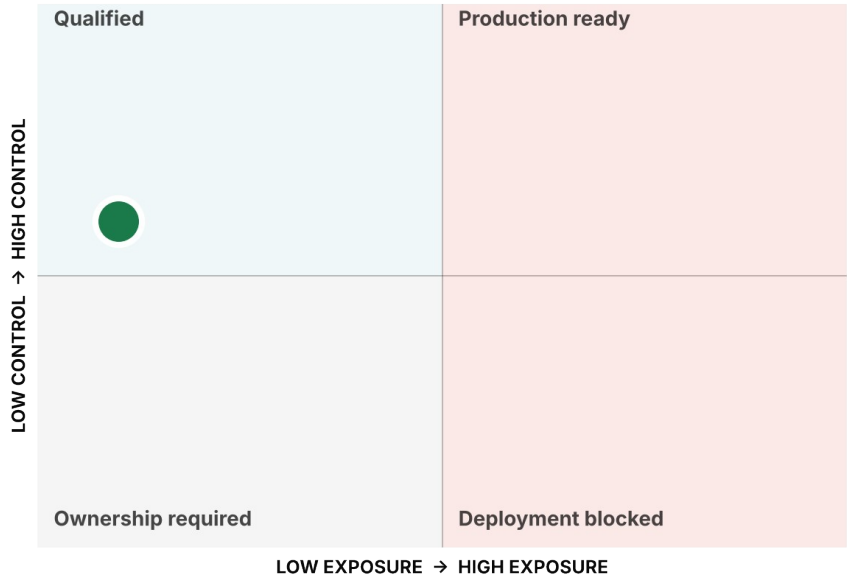
QUALIFIED
WITH CONDITIONS

Deployment may proceed within the assessed scope, subject to the mandatory conditions set out in this report.

Named accountable owner confirmed. Deployment exposure and control signals are within the qualified range.

Named owner: Helen Marsh, Chief Compliance Officer

How much could go wrong (exposure)	**Low (10/100) - this system has limited reach and doesn't make high-stakes decisions alone**
How well it's controlled (control)	**Strong (60/100) - a named accountable owner is confirmed, though stop/pause authority and senior-level or board visibility are not yet established**



Quadrant position: Qualified

REASSESSMENT REQUIRED

HOW WE REACHED THIS DECISION

Question	Answer
Is someone officially in charge of this AI system?	**Yes**
Can that person stop or pause it if something goes wrong?	**No**
Does senior leadership or the board know about it?	**No**
How much does the AI decide on its own?	**Not provided**
How widely will it be used?	**Department**
Deployment-blocking governance signals identified	**None**

These answers, assessed against the version referenced above, will always reproduce this verdict. A different verdict means a different answer, not a different day.

QUALIFICATION OPINION

AQE has completed a deterministic qualification assessment against Framework 2.0.4, incorporating gap library version 2026-02.

Based on the evidence supplied, the proposed AI deployment is qualified subject to the conditions set out below.

The principal reasons are:

- No confirmed stop authority held by the named owner.
- No confirmed board or senior visibility of this deployment.
- Deployment control score falls below the full qualification threshold.

Why qualification was granted

AQE identified the deficiencies described elsewhere in this report. However:

- Named executive accountability exists (Helen Marsh, Chief Compliance Officer).
- Deployment exposure remains limited.
- No deployment-blocking qualification signals were identified.

Accordingly, AQE determined that controlled deployment may proceed subject to the conditions described in this report.

AQE recommends reassessment following completion of the mandatory actions identified within this report.

Same inputs will always reproduce this verdict.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Qualification decision	Qualified with Conditions
Named accountable owner	Helen Marsh, Chief Compliance Officer
How much could go wrong	Low (10/100)
How well it's controlled	Strong (60/100)
Areas that still need work	Data Readiness, Process Maturity, Tooling & Infrastructure, People & Capability, Governance & Compliance
Mandatory actions before reassessment	15
Indicative reassessment timing	Extended - typically 8 or more weeks

Reassessment timing is an indicative band derived from the number of mandatory actions outstanding. It is not a guarantee and is not derived from measured completion data.

01 Dimension Signal Summary

Dimension	Signal	Qualification impact
Data Readiness	**CONDITIONAL**	Needs to be fixed before full qualification
Process Maturity	**CONDITIONAL**	Needs to be fixed before full qualification
Tooling & Infrastructure	**CONDITIONAL**	Needs to be fixed before full qualification
People & Capability	**CONDITIONAL**	Needs to be fixed before full qualification
Governance & Compliance	**CONDITIONAL**	Needs to be fixed before full qualification

Scope: AI deployment supporting Use AI to draft client suitability letters. This qualification applies to that deployment, not the organisation as a whole.

02 Qualification Evidence

Findings are derived directly from intake responses. Each reflects a specific gap identified.

Findings reference regulatory frameworks to identify evidence gaps against named obligations. They are not legal advice and are not a determination that the organisation is in breach of any law or regulation. Independent legal advice should be sought before relying on this report for compliance purposes.

Data Readiness: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Data assets are partially identified. Gaps in coverage will limit AI scope.
- Mix of structured and unstructured data. Structuring effort needed for target use cases.
- Partial cloud migration or mixed storage. Accessibility is constrained.
- Data quality is poor or unknown. AI outputs will be unreliable. Quality remediation is a prerequisite.
- No data lineage documentation. It is unclear which data feeds which system or model. This is a governance risk.

Required before Full Qualification

- Establish routine data quality monitoring for the datasets in scope.
- Document data lineage for the datasets in scope, so provenance is traceable before AI use.
- Classify the data in scope and bring the key unstructured sources into a structured, queryable form.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 4.0 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

Process Maturity: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Some repetitive processes exist but are not fully mapped.
- Some decision patterns exist but criteria are inconsistent.
- Bottlenecks are known but not quantified.
- Criteria are partially consistent. Some standardisation required.
- Some automation attempted with mixed results. Lessons available.

Required before Full Qualification

- Identify and quantify the process bottlenecks so AI scope and success measures can be set.

- Review past automation attempts and record what worked and what failed before committing to AI deployment.
- Define the decision rules within those processes so the same inputs lead to the same outcome.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 4.8 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

Tooling & Infrastructure: CONDITIONAL

Positive signals

- AI tools actively used with clear understanding of scope.

Qualification gaps

- Modern tools exist but integration gaps limit AI potential.
- No oversight controls cover AI tool use, current or future. Any informal (shadow) AI use would be ungoverned. For FCA-regulated firms, unlogged AI-assisted customer decisions may raise Consumer Duty and SM&CR considerations.
- Partial integration. Manual data transfers in use.
- Some legacy constraints. Workarounds are available but add cost. For FCA-regulated contexts, workarounds that bypass audit logging or data lineage controls are not acceptable.

Required before Full Qualification

- Put documented governance and oversight in place for all AI tool use, formal or informal.
- Replace manual data transfers between systems with integrated, logged data flows.
- Resolve or document legacy constraints, ensuring no workaround bypasses audit logging or data lineage.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 5.2 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

People & Capability: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Awareness exists but capability to act is limited.
- No AI ownership exists. Without a named owner, governance cannot function.
- Leadership interest but no formal mandate or budget.
- No AI training has taken place. Staff operating AI tools without understanding limitations or risk.

Required before Full Qualification

- Assign a named accountable owner for AI, with a defined escalation path.
- Put AI literacy training in place for staff who use, or will use, AI tools.
- Formalise leadership mandate and budget for AI governance beyond informal interest.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 4 questions in this area, averaging 3.8 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

Governance & Compliance: CONDITIONAL

Qualification gaps

- Regulations are known but compliance mapping is incomplete.
- Automated decisions affecting individuals are live with no documentation or oversight. UK GDPR Article 22 exposure.
- Some policies exist but are not comprehensive or current.
- No DPIA conducted. Typically required under UK GDPR Article 35 for high-risk processing. This is flagged as a priority evidence gap. The absence of a DPIA is an area where the ICO has shown enforcement interest.
- Some evidence exists but is not structured or audit-ready. Evidence should be structured to support FCA supervision and ICO inquiry, unstructured notes do not satisfy regulatory expectations.

Required before Full Qualification

- Document how AI contributes to decisions affecting individuals, and put human oversight in place for each.
- Complete or update the risk and impact assessment for each AI deployment in scope.
- Complete the mapping of applicable AI regulatory obligations to specific controls.

Qualification impact: Needs to be fixed before full qualification

How this was scored: Based on 5 questions in this area, averaging 3.6 out of 10. A score of 7 or higher is needed to pass this area without conditions.

03 Required Actions Before Full Qualification

Actions are grouped by area. Each one comes from a specific answer that scored below the pass level, lowest-scoring first.

Data Readiness

1	Establish routine data quality monitoring for the datasets in scope.
2	Document data lineage for the datasets in scope, so provenance is traceable before AI use.
3	Classify the data in scope and bring the key unstructured sources into a structured, queryable form.

Process Maturity

4	Identify and quantify the process bottlenecks so AI scope and success measures can be set.
5	Review past automation attempts and record what worked and what failed before committing to AI deployment.
6	Define the decision rules within those processes so the same inputs lead to the same outcome.

Tooling & Infrastructure

7	Put documented governance and oversight in place for all AI tool use, formal or informal.
8	Replace manual data transfers between systems with integrated, logged data flows.
9	Resolve or document legacy constraints, ensuring no workaround bypasses audit logging or data lineage.

People & Capability

10	Assign a named accountable owner for AI, with a defined escalation path.
11	Put AI literacy training in place for staff who use, or will use, AI tools.
12	Formalise leadership mandate and budget for AI governance beyond informal interest.

Governance & Compliance

13	Document how AI contributes to decisions affecting individuals, and put human oversight in

	place for each.
14	Complete or update the risk and impact assessment for each AI deployment in scope.
15	Complete the mapping of applicable AI regulatory obligations to specific controls.

04 What Happens Next

This deployment is qualified to proceed, subject to the conditions listed in Section 03. Complete those actions, then request a reassessment. A new certificate will be issued confirming full qualification once they're met.

Priority areas identified by client: Advice and client servicing

05 Qualification Obligations

Partial governance controls exist but gaps remain. Current posture may not satisfy UK GDPR or FCA expectations under scrutiny. Governance uplift recommended, specifically: DPIA completion, policy formalisation, and accountability mapping.

Obligation	Relevance	Status
UK GDPR Article 22	Automated decision-making affecting individuals	REVIEW
UK GDPR Article 35	DPIA required for high-risk AI processing	REVIEW
FCA Consumer Duty	AI outputs must demonstrably serve customer interests	REVIEW
EU AI Act Annex III	High-risk classification assessment	UNASSESSED

This report was produced using the AI Qualification Engine (AQE). Findings are consistent for the same inputs. This report does not constitute legal or regulatory advice.

This page explains how the Deployment Exposure and Deployment Control scores on the Qualification Decision page were derived.

Deployment Exposure (0-100)

Derived from the decision class this system operates in (informational through fully autonomous), the scale of deployment (single team through enterprise-wide), and the number of deployment-blocking governance signals identified elsewhere in this report. Higher autonomy, wider scale, and more blocking signals increase the score.

Deployment Control (0-100)

Derived from whether a named accountable owner is confirmed, whether that owner holds authority to stop or delay the deployment unilaterally, and whether the deployment has confirmed board or senior-level visibility. Absence of a named owner caps this score regardless of the other factors.

Governance & Compliance override

A Governance & Compliance dimension result of ESCALATE combined with high deployment exposure results in Not Qualified regardless of the scores above. Combined with low exposure, it caps the outcome at Qualified with Conditions.

Thresholds and reproducibility

Thresholds and scoring weights are fixed for a given framework version and do not vary between runs, between organisations, or over time. The same inputs assessed against the same framework version will always reproduce the same scores and the same verdict.

AQE is an independent qualification engine.

Qualification decisions are generated using deterministic, version-controlled rules.

No assessor discretion alters a qualification outcome.

Reports are reproducible.

Evidence is retained.

Framework versions are immutable.

Rules are version controlled.

Same inputs = Same verdict.